Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

Thursday 11 June 2026
Morning (Time: 1 hour 30 minutes)

PAPER REFERENCE
1HI0/31

History

Paper 3: Modern depth study

Option 31: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918–39

Sources/Interpretations Booklet

Do not return this Booklet with the question paper.

Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.
This booklet contains Source B, Source C, Interpretation 1 and Interpretation 2 for use with Question 3 on the question paper.

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Sources/Interpretations for use with Section B.

Sources for use with Questions 3(a) and 3(c).

Source B

A photograph showing members of the League of German Maidens (BDM) practicing domestic skills in a specialized training center, 1937.



Source C

From a secret report by the Social Democratic Party in exile (SOPADE), 1938.

"We must report that enthusiasm for the Hitler Youth is declining rapidly. Now that membership has been made compulsory, the teenagers view the meetings as a boring chore rather than an exciting adventure. The boys are highly rebellious against the military drill and the constant marching in the mud. In this district, usually only a third of the group appears for roll-call. At evening meetings, it is a great event if 20 turn up out of 80, but usually there are only about 10 or 12. The youth leaders, who are barely older than the members, act with arrogance, which causes deep resentment. Many parents are secretly supporting their children's absenteeism to protect them from this mind-numbing militarism."

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Interpretations for use with Section B.

Interpretations for use with Questions 3(b), 3(c) and 3(d).

Interpretation 1

From Indoctrinating a Generation by Dr. Klaus Fischer, published in 1995.

"The Nazi regime was highly successful in achieving its primary aim of controlling and brainwashing the minds of the younger generation. By coordinating both the school curriculum and leisure time, the state successfully isolated children from traditional family and religious influences. The Hitler Youth and the BDM met strong emotional needs for community, adventure, and belonging among teenagers. The constant physical training, ideological lectures, and military drilling successfully produced a generation of fanatical, loyal supporters of Adolf Hitler. Even when the war broke out, this indoctrination ensured that young Germans conformed and fought with unmatched fanaticism, proving that the Nazification of the youth was a complete success."

Interpretation 2

From Youth and Rebellion in the Third Reich by Dr. Arno Kitson, published in 2001.

"The Nazification of German youth was only a superficial success that masked growing boredom, resentment, and active rebellion. While the regime succeeded in forcing millions of teenagers into its youth organisations through compulsory membership laws in 1936, it failed to win their hearts and minds. As the 1930s progressed, the Hitler Youth became increasingly militarized, and the exciting camping trips were replaced by repetitive, grueling military drill. This led to massive absenteeism, passive non-conformity, and the rise of illegal, breakaway youth groups like the Edelweiss Pirates and the Swing Youth. These groups deliberately rejected Nazi discipline, proving that the regime's youth policies had failed to secure total control."

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